



S U N D A Y

LOVE:

THE OVERARCHING FRUIT

“But the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness, self-control; against such things there is no law.”

Galatians 5:22, 23

Let's learn about fruit from around the World:

MANGO

Mango is usually an oval shaped or oblong fruit with a firm yellowish-red skin. It has a hard central seed, and juicy sweet-smelling pulp. Mangos are one of the world's most popular fruits, this is likely due to their creamy but fruity taste. It is not a surprise that mango is known as the King of fruits in India, with 500+ varieties of mangos. Today you can find mangos anywhere in the world, but they are native to Southern Asia, India, Latin America, and the Caribbean.

Mango symbolizes love in India, and a basket of mangos is considered a gesture of friendship. In many Latin American countries, you'll find many street vendors offering mango on a stick, and in some places like in Mexico, they add lime juice and chili powder as a topping.

TODAY'S SPIRITUAL FRUIT IS

LOVE

In Galatians 5:22 and 23, the Apostle Paul announces: “But the fruit of the Spirit is **love**, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness, self-control; against such things there is no law.”

Here, Paul arrives at the heart of the message being delivered between verses 13-26 on what it really means for someone to have freedom in Jesus.

In Galatians 5:13 Paul proposes: “For you were called to freedom, brothers and sisters; only do not turn your freedom into an opportunity for the flesh, but serve one another through love.” By these words, Paul indicates that being truly free does not mean doing anything we feel like. Rather, living a life of obedience to God, representing the essence of God Who is love.

What we have come to know as the **fruit of the Spirit**, is really the culmination of the contrast the Apostle Paul is making between those who “Walk in the Spirit” (v. 16) and those who live by “the desire of the flesh” (v. 17). Essentially, the message being communicated is that if we belong to Jesus we will “love your neighbor as yourself” (v. 14).

The Bible is clear that love is the all-encompassing response of the true follower of Jesus. Yes, love is the result of a life lived for Jesus and lived in Jesus. And, just in case someone is thinking of love as a sentimental and fuzzy feeling, the Apostle Paul leaves no doubt about what he means when he shares: “Love is patient, love is kind, it is not jealous; love does not brag, it is not arrogant” (1 Cor 13:4).

On the idea of producing the fruit of **love**, Ellen White says: “Obedience to the word produces fruit of the required quality—‘unfeigned love of the brethren.’ This love is heaven-born and leads to high motives and unselfish actions.” (*Acts of the Apostles*, p. 519)

The truth is, farmers can plow, fertilize, and tend—but whether a crop succeeds in producing fruit is still the result of God’s divine gift of life. Likewise, it is through Christ’s freely given sacrifice that those living by His Spirit can expect to produce the Spirit’s fruit. This, of course, translates into being patient, kind, gentle and faithful in all our relationships; especially in our family relationships.

Today we urge you to pick the fruit of love. However, as a new day is born, pick a fruit each day that flows from God’s love—the central principle of your life—and by so doing become a blessing in your marriage, in your home, and in every one of your relationships until Jesus comes again.

PRAY:

Dear Heavenly Father, thank You for Your precious love that surrounds us always. Help us to love one another with that kind of love today. In the name of Jesus, amen.



FRUITFUL **LOVE** ACTIVITY

You will need:

- A large sheet of paper for each person,
- Pencils, crayons, marker pens, etc.

Instructions:

- Give each of your family members a large sheet of paper and ask them to draw a big heart on the paper.
- Ask them to write inside their hearts ten things that other people have done which made them feel especially loved.
- When they have finished writing ten things that made them feel loved ask them to:
- Draw a red circle around the times someone said or wrote something loving.
- Draw a green circle around the times when someone did something to help you.
- Draw a blue circle around the times when someone showed you affection, like a hug.
- Draw a yellow circle around the times someone gave you a little gift.
- Draw a purple circle around the times someone spent time with you, doing something you enjoyed.
- Look at the colors on each of your hearts. What have you learned about the special ways in which you all like to be loved?
- Plan to do something loving for each person in your family this week, inspired by the ways they most like to be loved.



BIBLE VERSE ACTIVITY

You will need:

- Paper or card stock, in different colors if you like
- A heart template to draw around – fold paper and cut half a heart shape with the fold in the center – open out and check the heart shape, refold, and trim if necessary
- Scissors
- Pencils and coloring materials
- Hole punch (or cut slits in the hearts instead of punching holes)
- Yarn, string, ribbon, etc.

Instructions:

- Cut out one paper heart for each word in the Bible verse, plus an extra one for the Bible reference.
- Punch one hole on each side of each heart, near the top, in the same place on each shape, so that they can be threaded onto yarn, string, or ribbon to make a garland.
- Write each word from the verse on a separate heart shape and decorate the hearts if you like.
- Take it in turns to shuffle the hearts and then rearrange them in the right order to make the verse.

— **QUESTIONS** — TO TALK ABOUT TOGETHER

- Showing love to each other is a fruit of the Spirit because...
- Jesus showed love when...
- Other Bible characters who showed love for others were...
- I find it hardest to act in a loving way when...
- Some things that help me to be more loving to others are...
- One time that I was loving this week was when...
- One time when someone was loving towards me this week was...
- We can help each other to be more loving by...